

Instructor Notes – Alternative Variants for Researchers & Professional Staff

Overview

These notes give **lightweight variants** of each activity for participants who are mainly:

- **Researchers**, or
- **Professional staff** (e.g., Teaching Support Officers, Learning Designers, Coordinators, Academic Operations).

Use them as verbal prompts in the room rather than full slide content.

Suggested phrasing:

“If you’re mainly here as a researcher or professional staff member, feel free to adapt each activity to your world. Here are a few options...”

Activity 1 – Automate the Tedious (Summariser + Twist)

Core pattern: summarise → recast for a purpose.

Researchers

- Summarise a **paper abstract** or **methods section**, then:
 - Twist: “Write a plain-English summary for a **funding application’s non-technical summary** section.”
 - Twist: “Turn this into **3 conference slide headings + bullets**.”
- Summarise **reviewer comments**, then:
 - Twist: “Draft a **polite, point-by-point response letter**.”

Professional Staff

- Summarise a **policy / procedure / meeting paper**, then:
 - Twist: “Turn this into a **staff bulletin** or **FAQ** for students.”
 - Twist: “Draft an **internal email** explaining what’s changed and what actions are needed.”
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Activity 2 – The Art of the Prompt (Prompt Makeover)

Core pattern: vague → structured prompt for their own work.

Researchers

- Vague: “Help me with my literature review.”
- Structured:
 - Context: field, topic, stage of PhD/project.
 - Role: “You are a research assistant...”
 - Action: “Cluster these papers into **3–5 themes + gaps**.”
 - Format: table with “**Theme**”, “**Key papers**”, “**Open questions**”.

Other uses:

- Designing prompts to:
 - Generate **potential journal venues**.
 - Draft **conference abstracts**.
 - Suggest **interview questions** or **survey items**.

Professional Staff

- Vague: “Write an email about enrolment.”
 - Structured:
 - Context: office/function, target group, timelines.
 - Role: “You are a student communications officer...”
 - Action: “Draft **2 versions** of this message: one formal email, one short LMS announcement.”
 - Format/constraints: word limits, tone, bullet points, calls to action.
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Activity 3 – 5-Step Critique Framework

Core pattern: critique AI outputs using Purpose, Plausibility, Evidence, Stakes, Action.

Researchers

Examples to critique:

- AI-generated:
 - **literature summary**
 - **draft abstract**
 - “**related work**” paragraph

Prompt questions:

- Purpose: “Is this fit for the **intended venue** (journal/conference)?”
- Plausibility/Evidence: “Does this reflect how our field actually talks?” “Are key authors/theories missing?”
- Stakes: “What happens if I trust this in a **grant or paper**?”

Professional Staff

Examples to critique:

- AI-generated:
 - **student information email**
 - **web page copy** about a process (extensions, scholarships, progress)
 - **FAQ** for staff or students

Prompt questions:

- Plausibility: “Does this really match how our systems/policies work?”
- Stakes: “What if a student acts on wrong or incomplete information?”

Activity 4 – Unlocking the Impossible (Assessment Stress-Test Variant)

Core pattern: 3-step chain – AI does task → critique → redesign.

Researchers

Use a **research-adjacent task** that feels “impossible”, for example:

- Designing a **data collection plan**.
- Drafting a **grant impact/significance** section.

Workflow:

1. Ask AI to draft the plan/section.
2. Critique: Is it generic? Feasible? Ethically sound?
3. Ask AI for **2–3 improvements**, then decide what you would actually keep.

Professional Staff

Stress-test a **process communication**, not an assessment:

1. Paste a real process description (e.g., special consideration, course transfer).
2. Ask AI to produce a **student-facing explanation**.
3. Critique: Where is it misleading, incomplete, or tone-deaf?
4. Ask AI for improvements, then apply your own judgement.

If you're running the strict **assessment stress-test** with the room, researchers/professional staff can simply **mentally map** to parallel processes in their roles.

Activity 5 – Secure, Safe, and Sustainable AI

Core pattern: one concrete, context-specific guideline / statement / risk check.

Researchers

Possible micro-tasks:

- Draft a short “**AI in this project**” statement, including:
 - What AI **can/can't** be used for (e.g., coding, drafting text, *not* analysing identifiable data without ethics approval).
 - How AI use will be **documented** (lab notebook, methods section, appendix).
- Run a risk/benefit check for using AI to:

- analyse **interview transcripts**, or
- draft parts of an **ethics application**.

Professional Staff

Possible micro-tasks:

- Draft a one-paragraph “**AI use in this team/office**” guideline, identifying:
 - Allowed uses (drafting comms, summarising docs, idea generation).
 - Prohibited uses (student records, HR data, confidential documents).
 - Draft a **Week-1 statement** for a staff training or induction session that explains:
 - How AI may be used to support staff.
 - Expectations around **disclosure** and **checking accuracy**.
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Short In-Room Script

You can summarise all of this verbally, e.g.:

- “If you’re mainly here as a **researcher or professional staff member**, feel free to adapt each activity to your world:
- Activity 1: summarise a **paper or policy**;
 - Activity 2: improve a **research/admin prompt**;
 - Activity 3: critique an AI-generated **abstract or email**;
 - Activity 4: stress-test a **grant section or process description**;
 - Activity 5: draft one **AI guideline or statement** for your team or project.”